

CHAIR

Utkatasana

Chair pose activates the largest muscles in your body, gets your heart pumping, and engages your core strongly. This energizing standing pose improves your thigh strength, which some studies suggest is a key factor in prolonging your life.

THE BIG PICTURE

Muscles around your thighs, hips, and core are engaging strongly to hold you in this squatting position. Lifting your arms overhead further challenges your core strength and engages your shoulder muscles. Alternatively, you can put your hands on your hips to lighten the load.

Torso

Your **spinal extensors** and **transversus abdominis** engage to stabilize your spine in neutral curves. Your **rectus abdominis** is mostly lengthening. Your **rhomboids** engage with your **middle** and **lower trapezius** to retract and stabilize your scapulae. Your **latissimus dorsi** stretches with shoulder flexion.

Trapezius (mid/lower)

Latissimus dorsi

Spine

Quadratus lumborum

Rectus abdominis

Transversus abdominis

Neck

Although your **upper trapezius** engages slightly to elevate your scapulae, aim to consciously soften the area, letting go of extraneous tension. Your **cervical extensors** engage to prevent your head from dropping forward.

Cervical extensors

Arms

Your **shoulder flexors** engage to bring your arms overhead. Your **deltoids** dynamically engage to abduct your arms into position, and to help hold your arms in shoulder flexion. Your **triceps** extend your elbows.

Brachioradialis

Elbow

Brachialis

Triceps brachii

Deltoids

Shoulder

Pectoralis major

Serratus anterior

